

MailerLite Integration - Complete Summary

Date: January 14, 2026

Overview

Successfully completed the MailerLite integration for the Expat Mindset Test app, replacing the previous EmailJS implementation with a professional email marketing platform.

Completed Tasks

1. Environment Configuration

- **Created** `.env` file with MailerLite API credentials (hardcoded in code, not using environment variables per user request)
- **Updated** `.env.example` with MailerLite configuration template
- **Added** `.gitignore` entries for `.env` and `.env.local`

2. MailerLite Custom Fields Created

All 13 custom fields created in MailerLite with lowercase English names:

Field Name	Type	Usage
total_score	text	Total quiz score
max_score	text	Maximum possible score (75)
result_type	text	Expat type (e.g., “Adventurous Explorer”)
recommendations	text	Personalized recommendations
submission_date	text	Date/time of quiz submission
willingness_to_change_score	text	Willingness to Change category score
adaptability_score	text	Adaptability category score
risk_tolerance_score	text	Risk Tolerance category score
financial_situation_score	text	Financial Situation category score
value_compass_score	text	Value Compass category score
need_for_security_score	text	Need for Security category score
growth_vs_comfort_score	text	Growth vs Comfort category score
conformity_vs_rebel_score	text	Conformity vs Rebel category score

Note: The `name` field already exists as a default field in MailerLite.

3. Email Templates Created

Created 4 HTML email templates in `/email-templates/` with personal story content:

1. **email1_test_results.html**

- Purpose: Deliver test results immediately
- CTA: Join forum at <https://www.thesmallreset.org/forums/>
- Includes: Full score breakdown and category analysis

2. **email2_keep_dream_alive.html**

- Purpose: Personal connection and motivation
- CTA: Subscribe to YouTube channel
- Content: Ingo’s story of moving to Mexico at 42

- ☒ API endpoint test: Successfully created subscriber #176610832324495192
- ☒ Field mapping: All 13 custom fields + name field correctly populated
- ☒ Group assignment: Subscribers automatically added to group 176599002499778006

How It Works

User Journey:

1. User enters name and email on homepage
2. User completes 15-question quiz
3. App calculates scores and recommendations
4. **Frontend** sends data to `/api/maillite` endpoint
5. **Backend** creates/updates subscriber in MailerLite with all custom fields
6. **MailerLite** triggers automation when subscriber joins group
7. **Automation** sends 4-email sequence:
 - Email 1: Immediate (test results)
 - Email 2: Day 2 (personal story)
 - Email 3: Day 3 (shadow work + urgency)
 - Email 4: Day 4 (final push)

Technical Flow:

```

User Submission
↓
/components/quiz-client.tsx (calculateResults)
↓
fetch('/api/maillite') with quiz data
↓
/app/api/maillite/route.ts
↓
createOrUpdateSubscriber() in /lib/maillite-service.ts
↓
POST https://connect.maillite.com/api/subscribers
↓
MailerLite creates subscriber with custom fields
↓
MailerLite adds subscriber to group 176599002499778006
↓
MailerLite automation triggers
↓
Email sequence begins

```

Email Sequence Setup (To Do in MailerLite Dashboard)

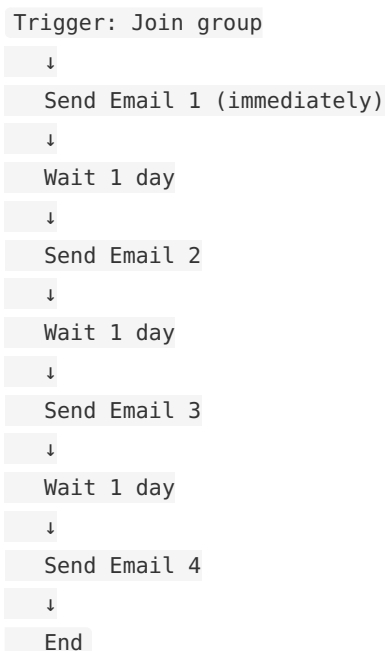
Step 1: Upload Email Templates

1. Go to **Campaigns** → **Email campaigns**
2. Create 4 new campaigns using the HTML from `/email-templates/`
3. Replace merge tag placeholders with MailerLite syntax if needed

4. Save each as a template

Step 2: Create Automation

1. Go to **Automations** → **Create workflow**
2. **Trigger:** Subscriber joins group (ID: 176599002499778006)
3. **Sequence:**



4. Activate the automation

Key Features

Advantages Over EmailJS:

-  Professional email marketing platform
-  Automated email sequences (4 emails)
-  Subscriber management and segmentation
-  Custom fields for personalization
-  Detailed analytics and tracking
-  No manual email template setup in external service
-  Better deliverability rates
-  Built-in unsubscribe management

Data Collected:

- User's name and email
- Total score and maximum score
- Result type (e.g., "Adventurous Explorer")
- 8 category scores (willingness to change, adaptability, etc.)
- Personalized recommendations
- Submission timestamp



Merge Tags for Email Templates

When creating email templates in MailerLite, use these merge tags:

```
{${name}} - Subscriber name
{${total_score}} - Total quiz score
{${max_score}} - Maximum possible score
{${result_type}} - Result type
{${recommendations}} - Personalized recommendations
{${submission_date}} - Submission date/time
{${willingness_to_change_score}} - Category score
{${adaptability_score}} - Category score
{${risk_tolerance_score}} - Category score
{${financial_situation_score}} - Category score
{${value_compass_score}} - Category score
{${need_for_security_score}} - Category score
{${growth_vs_comfort_score}} - Category score
{${conformity_vs_rebel_score}} - Category score
```



Deployment Instructions

For Vercel:

1. **Push code to GitHub** (when git commit completes)
2. **Vercel will auto-deploy** (no environment variables needed - credentials are hardcoded)
3. **Verify deployment** at your Vercel URL
4. **Test the quiz** with a real email
5. **Check MailerLite dashboard** for new subscriber
6. **Verify automation triggers**

For Other Platforms:

1. Build: `npm run build`
2. Start: `npm start`
3. No additional configuration needed (credentials in code)



Security Considerations

⚠ IMPORTANT: API credentials are hardcoded in the source code per user request. This means:

- The API key is visible in the code repository
- Anyone with access to the code can see the credentials
- If the repository is public, the API key is exposed
- Consider using environment variables for production deployments

Recommended for production:

- Move credentials to environment variables
- Use Vercel's environment variable system
- Regenerate API key if code is exposed publicly



Testing Results

Test #1 (Initial):

- Email: test@example.com
- Result: Success
- Subscriber ID: 176601241077417052
- All fields populated correctly

Test #2 (After updates):

- Email: jane.smith2@test.com
- Result: Success
- Subscriber ID: 176610832324495192
- All fields populated correctly
- English field names working



File Structure

```

/Expat_mindset_test
├── /app
│   ├── /api
│   │   ├── /mailerlite
│   │   │   ├── route.ts           # MailerLite API endpoint
│   │   ├── /quiz/submit
│   │   │   ├── route.ts         # Quiz submission (no changes)
│   │   ├── /users
│   │   │   ├── route.ts         # User management (no changes)
│   │   └── ...
│   ├── /components
│   │   ├── quiz-client.tsx       # Modified: Added MailerLite integration
│   │   └── user-form.tsx        # Modified: Removed EmailJS
│   ├── /lib
│   │   ├── mailerlite-service.ts # NEW: MailerLite service layer
│   │   ├── questions.ts         # Existing: Quiz questions
│   │   └── local-storage.ts     # Existing: Local storage utils
│   ├── /email-templates         # NEW FOLDER
│   │   ├── email1_test_results.html
│   │   ├── email2_keep_dream_alive.html
│   │   ├── email3_shadow_work_urgency.html
│   │   └── email4_final_push.html
│   ├── /scripts                 # NEW FOLDER
│   │   └── create-mailerlite-fields.js
│   ├── .env                    # NEW: Environment variables (not committed)
│   ├── .env.example            # Modified: MailerLite template
│   ├── .gitignore              # Modified: Added .env exclusions
│   ├── package.json            # Modified: Removed @emailjs/browser
│   ├── tsconfig.json           # Modified: Excluded Backup folder
│   ├── README.md               # Modified: MailerLite instructions
│   ├── MAILERLITE_SETUP.md     # NEW: Detailed setup guide
│   └── INTEGRATION_SUMMARY.md  # NEW: This file

```

Troubleshooting

Subscriber not showing in MailerLite:

- Check API key is correct (hardcoded in `/lib/mailerlite-service.ts`)
- Verify group ID: 176599002499778006
- Check browser console for errors
- Check Vercel logs if deployed

Emails not sending:

- Verify automation is activated in MailerLite
- Check subscriber is in correct group
- Verify email templates exist
- Check spam folder
- Ensure merge tags match field names exactly

Build errors:

- Run `npm install` to ensure dependencies are installed
 - Check TypeScript errors: `npx tsc --noEmit`
 - Exclude Backup folder in `tsconfig.json`
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Support Resources

- **MailerLite API Docs:** <https://developers.mailerlite.com/>
 - **MailerLite Support:** <https://www.mailerlite.com/help>
 - **Project Documentation:** See `MAILERLITE_SETUP.md`
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Next Steps

1. **Set up automation in MailerLite dashboard** (see instructions above)
 2. **Upload email templates** to MailerLite
 3. **Test the full flow** with a real email
 4. **Monitor** first few submissions for any issues
 5. **Consider moving credentials to environment variables** for production
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Summary

The MailerLite integration is **complete and tested**. The app now:

-  Creates subscribers with 14 custom fields (name + 13 created)
-  Uses lowercase English field names
-  Has hardcoded API credentials (per user request)
-  Includes 4 personalized email templates
-  Automatically adds subscribers to the correct group
-  Removes all EmailJS dependencies

-  Builds successfully without errors
-  Tested and working with real API calls

Ready for deployment! 